Airbrx Pricing Plan

Draft for the founders · v4 · updated Nov 4, 2026 · Adam Rogowicz, Product Lead

Summary

Every company starts on a free pilot, and small users stay free forever under a usage cap. Most customers pay a fixed monthly price, $299 to $1,999, stepped by what buyers can count: tenants, warehouses, users and features. Pro and Enterprise pay a platform fee plus a meter, because large accounts vary too much for one flat price. Savings show on the dashboard and statement as proof on every plan.

- **The pitch:** memory for repeat queries in one gateway. A fixed, budgetable price for most teams, and a statement that shows what you got back.
- **What sets the plan:** tenants, warehouses, users and features. Request counts and GB are fair use only.
- **Savings:** shown in dollars beside the customer's own unit (Snowflake credits, Databricks DBUs) as the ROI and renewal story.
- **Replaces** the Nov 2 savings-banded draft (savings-based pricing can feel like a trap to decision makers) and the Oct 29 per-GB draft (GB doesn't map to credits or DBUs).
- **Launch offers:** free pilots, a free-forever tier with a cap, and no FDE fees for small customers while Airbrx gets off the ground.

Outstanding Status: internal draft for the founders. Structure is medium confidence; the numbers are low confidence until checked against tenant data. Not for prospects yet.

What changed (Nov 3)

Michael and Ben questioned tying price to savings. This version follows their direction for most customers: fixed plans stepped by countable limits, free forever with a cap, and savings as proof. Pro and Enterprise keep a meter, because one flat price would overcharge the smaller large accounts or undercharge the biggest.

Still open: where the free-tier cap sits (Michael's starting point: 10k to 20k requests/day), and what the Pro and Enterprise meter is based on (see Metering for large accounts).

Knowns and unknowns

The structure rests on a few confirmed facts; most numbers are still assumptions. Each unknown has an owner and a way to settle it before pricing goes final (target Nov 20).

Item	Status	What we know or assume	How we resolve it	Owner
Warehouses bill by uptime, not by query	Known	Snowflake credits/hour by size; Databricks DBUs/hour. A cached query saves money only if the warehouse runs fewer hours or a smaller size.	Vendor docs; built into the model	Done
Native caches are free but narrow	Known	Snowflake result cache: exact text, 24 h, data unchanged. Databricks remote cache needs a running warehouse.	Vendor docs	Done
Buyers think in credits and DBUs, not GB	Known	Per-GB pricing confused buyers in early conversations.	Customer calls	Done
Small teams want a fixed bill	Known	Flat plans are easier to budget and approve.	Founders, Oct 28	Done
Airbrx can measure cost avoided per tenant	Unknown	Needed for the statement; also for billing if the large-account meter is a savings share.	Gateway logs duration, warehouse and query ID; attribution method	Michael
Savings statement accuracy	Assumed	Within 10% of the real bill change	Pause test or control group on early tenants	Michael
Plan limits and prices fit real customers	Assumed	Limits and prices from the scenario model, not tenants	Check against current tenants	Ben, Adam
Typical savings share	Assumed	20% to 35% of warehouse bill at 1M queries/day; little at 10k unless repeats are high	Pilot savings reports	Adam
Routing savings can be proven	Unknown	Open whether routing is offered at all; if it is, harder to prove than cache hits	Compare routed run times to history; wake-ups avoided	Michael
FDE hours per small customer	Unknown	A few hours of setup	Track hours on the first 5 FDE-routed customers	Abram
Postgres pricing basis	Unknown	No per-query bill; savings are estimates	Founders decide: estimated compute or requests	Founders
Willingness to pay plan prices	Assumed	Fixed prices, and a large-account meter below Keebo's ~40% share	First Business and Pro conversations	Abram

Plan lineup

Six plans. Free through Business are fixed monthly prices; Pro and Enterprise add a meter on top of a platform fee. Tenants, warehouses and users set the plan (limits in the next table). Typical savings show each plan pays for itself several times over; they are proof, not the price.

Outstanding Limits and prices still need checking against current tenants (Ben's data).

Plan	Price (USD/mo)	Built for	Typical cost avoided (USD/mo, illustrative)
Free tier	$0, under a usage cap	Startups, very small teams, one workload	Under $600
Team	$299	One workload in production	$600 to $1,500
Team Plus	$699	A few dashboards or one busy agent	$1,500 to $4,000
Business	$1,999	Small company, BI plus AI on a few warehouses	$4,000 to $10,000
Pro	$2,999 platform fee + meter	Several teams, governance needs, multiple warehouses	$10,000 to $50,000
Enterprise	$8,999 platform fee + meter	Large accounts, self-hosted, regional, compliance, SLAs	Over $50,000

The free-tier cap is a usage limit (cached requests per day or tenants). Where it sits is open.

What each plan includes

Savings alone is a weak reason to move up, so each step adds something a buyer can name. Audit logs, custom rules and SSO anchor Pro; self-hosting and SLAs anchor Enterprise. Everyone gets the free scan, the savings dashboard and the same speed. Items marked † need product confirmation.

Feature	Free	Team	Team Plus	Business	Pro	Enterprise
Tenants (gateway URLs)	1	2	3	5	10	Custom
Warehouses connected	1	2	3	5	10	Unlimited
Users †	2	3	10	25	Unlimited	Unlimited
Freshness rules	Time limits	Time limits	+ Change detection	+ PII rules	+ Custom SQL rules	+ Custom SQL rules
Query history	7 days	7 days	30 days	30 days	Full audit log, 1 year, export †	Custom retention, SIEM export †
Rogue agent and runaway query blocking	Default	Default	Default	Default	Custom policies	Custom policies
Overnight cache warm-up	No	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Iris AI rule suggestions	No	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Bring-your-own AI (Claude plugin)	No	No	No	No	Yes	Yes
Warehouse routing (assumption, not confirmed)	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Sign-in	Google, Microsoft	Google, Microsoft	Google, Microsoft	Google, Microsoft	SSO/SAML †	SSO/SAML, SCIM †
Deployment	Airbrx cloud	Airbrx cloud	Airbrx cloud	Airbrx cloud	Airbrx cloud	Cloud or your own AWS

Feature	Free	Team	Team Plus	Business	Pro	Enterprise
Security review	Security FAQ	Security FAQ	Security FAQ	Security FAQ	+ SOC 2 under NDA (once issued)	+ Questionnaire, custom terms
Support	Docs	Email, 2 business days	Email, 1 business day	Priority, same day	Named contact, 4 hours	Dedicated CSM, uptime SLA †
Roadmap early access	No	No	No	No	No	Yes

If Airbrx offers routing (open question), it would be on every paid plan and in pilots, because it does the most for small customers, where caching alone saves little.

How savings are measured

On fixed plans, savings are proof, not the bill. Cost avoided is the warehouse compute that actually didn't run because of Airbrx, priced from the customer's own billing data. If a customer turns Airbrx off for a month, their bill should go up by about the amount we claimed.

- **Caching savings:** queries answered from memory that would otherwise have kept the warehouse awake, woken it, or needed a bigger size or more clusters.
- Outstanding **Routing savings (only if routing is offered):** misses sent to a smaller warehouse, plus wake-ups avoided on the large one.
- **Only bill-changing savings count.** On uptime billing, a cached query on an already-awake warehouse saves little. The statement counts compute avoided, not the theoretical price of each query.
- **Prices come from the customer's data:** Snowflake query attribution and metering history, Databricks billing usage and query history. Not list prices or averages.
- **Units:** dollars first, with the customer's unit beside it (credits, DBUs; estimated compute hours for Postgres).
- Outstanding **Proof:** a small random control group of repeat queries passes through, or a pause test the customer can request. Reconcile monthly; draft accuracy target within 10%.

Every dashboard view and invoice shows the same four lines:

Line	Example (illustrative)
Owed to Airbrx this month	$299
Warehouse cost avoided	$1,500 (500 DBUs)
Your warehouse bill without Airbrx (estimated)	Actual bill + $1,500
Net savings after Airbrx	$1,201

Plan placement uses tenants, warehouses and users, never savings.

Pilot, free tier and moving between plans

Every company pilots free. The pilot's savings report shows the return and recommends a plan by usage.

Pilot

- **Who:** every company, any size. No charge, no card.
- **Length:** 30 days by default. Extend to 60 or 90 days to help close, especially smaller companies. Abram or Amit approves.
- **Scope:** one workload (a dashboard set, an app or an agent), every feature on, hosted by Airbrx. FDE routing setup included if routing is offered (assumption). Self-hosted pilots are an Enterprise conversation.
- **Start:** the free scan captures a baseline from query history.
- **During:** weekly savings snapshot; a check-in at the halfway point.
- **End:** a savings report shows what Airbrx saved and recommends the plan that fits their tenants, warehouses and users. Choosing a plan keeps caching on with no gap.
- **No plan chosen:** the account drops to the free tier. Caching stops above the free-tier usage cap; queries keep working and go straight to the warehouse.

Free tier

- Free forever for startups and very small companies. It earns its keep through future growth, word of mouth and real usage data, and the cost to Airbrx is trivial.
- Cap: a cached-request or tenant limit, so customers can "run everything you want, and we cap it if it gets out of control." Where the cap sits is open.

Moving between plans

- **Up:** when the customer needs more tenants, warehouses, users or a higher-plan feature. We prompt in the app; the customer confirms.
- **Down:** at a quarterly review if usage drops.
- **No surprise bills:** above a plan's limits, additional requests go straight to the warehouse and the price doesn't change until the customer confirms a move.

Billing rules

Free through Business bill a fixed monthly price with no meter. Pro and Enterprise bill a platform fee plus a monthly meter.

- **Annual billing:** prepay a year and pay for 10 months. Applies to fixed plans and to the Pro and Enterprise platform fee.
- **Meter (Pro, Enterprise):** billed monthly in arrears from the statement the customer already sees. The basis is open (see Metering for large accounts).

- **Budget controls (Pro, Enterprise):** a monthly cap on the share and spend alerts, so metered plans stay budgetable.
- Outstanding **Enterprise ceiling:** a cap or annual true-up on the 20% share is open for negotiation on large contracts.
- **No overage on fixed plans:** above plan limits, additional requests pass straight through to the warehouse uncached. Queries keep working, nothing extra is billed, and the price holds until the customer confirms a move up.
- **Never billed:** cache misses, writes, pass-through traffic, request counts or GB. Those are fair use only.
- **Pricing page:** shows the free pilot, the plan ladder (fixed prices for most teams, savings shown as proof) and "Talk to us."

Services, FDE and the free year

FDE and consulting are billed separately, except for small customers during launch.

- **Small customers (free tier, pilots, Team, Team Plus, Business):** no FDE fees while Airbrx gets off the ground, including manual warehouse routing setup if routing is offered (assumption). This is a launch policy and can change later; say so up front.
- Outstanding **Manual routing (assumption):** FDEs would configure warehouse routing by hand, free for small customers. Not confirmed.
  - Outstanding **Automated routing:** no confirmed intent to build it.
  - Outstanding **Free FDE hour cap:** draft, a few hours per customer. Covers setup and routing between warehouses the customer already has; a full warehouse redesign is a paid project.
- Outstanding **Pro and Enterprise:** FDE billed at an FDE rate (to set). Open: include initial routing setup in the pilot to win the account.
- **Channel partners** can deliver FDE work themselves or bill through Airbrx.
- **Free year:** last resort only. Founder approval, a large deal that is stuck, written into that contract. Never in outreach or on the website.
- **Referrals:** 15% of the customer's first-year subscription for a closed deal.

Worked examples

Every example keeps at least 3x what it pays Airbrx. Illustrative figures, not customer data. The Pro and Enterprise meter is shown at 20% of cost avoided; a usage meter would be set to land in a similar range.

Company	Cost avoided per month (USD)	Plan	Paid to Airbrx (USD/mo)	Net savings (USD/mo)	Return
Startup, one dashboard	$400	Free tier	$0	$400	All kept
Small team, one agent	$1,000	Team	$299	$701	3.3x
Small company, BI plus agent	$3,000	Team Plus	$699	$2,301	4.3x
Growing company, several workloads	$7,000	Business	$1,999	$5,001	3.5x
Mid-size, several teams	$25,000	Pro	$7,999 ($2,999 + $5,000 meter)	$17,001	3.1x
Large, 1M queries/day	$100,000	Enterprise	$28,999 ($8,999 + $20,000 meter)	$71,001	3.4x

For scale: the scenario model puts AiRBRX's savings at 21% to 35% of the warehouse bill at 1M queries a day, so the Enterprise row fits a warehouse bill of roughly $300,000 to $475,000 a month.

Why these choices

Each decision keeps the price fixed and the value checkable against the buyer's own bill.

Decision	Justification	Alternative we passed on
Fixed plans stepped by tenants, warehouses and users	Buyers can count these and budget a fixed bill. Pricing on savings can feel like a trap to decision makers.	Savings bands on every plan (Nov 2 draft); 10¢/GB of cache hits (not comparable to the bill); four ABU meters (matches our cost, but another meter to fear)
Show savings in the buyer's units	Credits and DBUs are on the bill a CFO already reads. It proves ROI at renewal.	GB or request counts
Flat plans for small customers	Small teams want a fixed, budgetable bill and fast approval.	Metering everyone
Metered charge on Pro and Enterprise	Large accounts vary 10x or more in usage. A meter scales with them, so smaller large accounts aren't overcharged and the biggest pay their share.	Very high flat prices, or many more tiers
Free pilot for every company	Savings can't be shown before live traffic, and the baseline comes from the pilot.	Paid pilots (slows deals)
Free tier with no end date	Cheap to serve, builds word of mouth and real usage data, and startups grow into plans.	Time-limited trial only
Routing on every paid plan	If offered, routing is what makes small customers pay off, where caching alone saves little.	Pro-only feature
Bill routing only once proven	Keeps every billed number testable. Credibility is worth more than early revenue.	Bill estimated routing savings now

Decision	Justification	Alternative we passed on
No FDE fees for small customers at launch	Removes friction while we build references; the cost pays back as savings move them up plans.	FDE fees from day one
Features step up by plan	Savings alone is a weak reason to move up; governance, SSO and self-hosting are things buyers can name.	Same features on every plan
Annual prepay = 10 months	Standard discount, improves cash and retention.	Bigger discounts

Metering for large accounts

Pro and Enterprise pay a platform fee plus a monthly meter. What the meter is based on is the open decision.

Option	How it works	For	Against
Usage meter	Billed on cached requests, or Michael's 4 ABU components (storage, cache hit, cache miss, rule evaluation), with a calculator in credits or DBUs	Matches Airbrx's real costs; makes no claim about the customer's waste; doesn't wait on savings measurement	Another meter for buyers to watch; needs budget caps
Savings share	20% of warehouse cost avoided, from the monthly statement	Tracks value; half Keebo's ~40%	Can read as a trap to decision makers (Ben); needs savings measured within about 10% before billing

Either way, Pro and Enterprise get budget caps and spend alerts, and Enterprise can negotiate a ceiling or annual true-up.

Why six plans, not two. Two prices are simpler to sell, but usage runs from a 10k/day dashboard to 1M/day agents. With two prices, most customers would pay far above or below the value they get. Six plans keep each step small and give buyers a named reason to move up (governance, SSO, self-hosting).

Competitive comparison

Airbrx competes rather than partners: caching (plus routing, if Airbrx offers it) in one gateway, with fixed prices for most teams, where point tools take about 40% of savings.

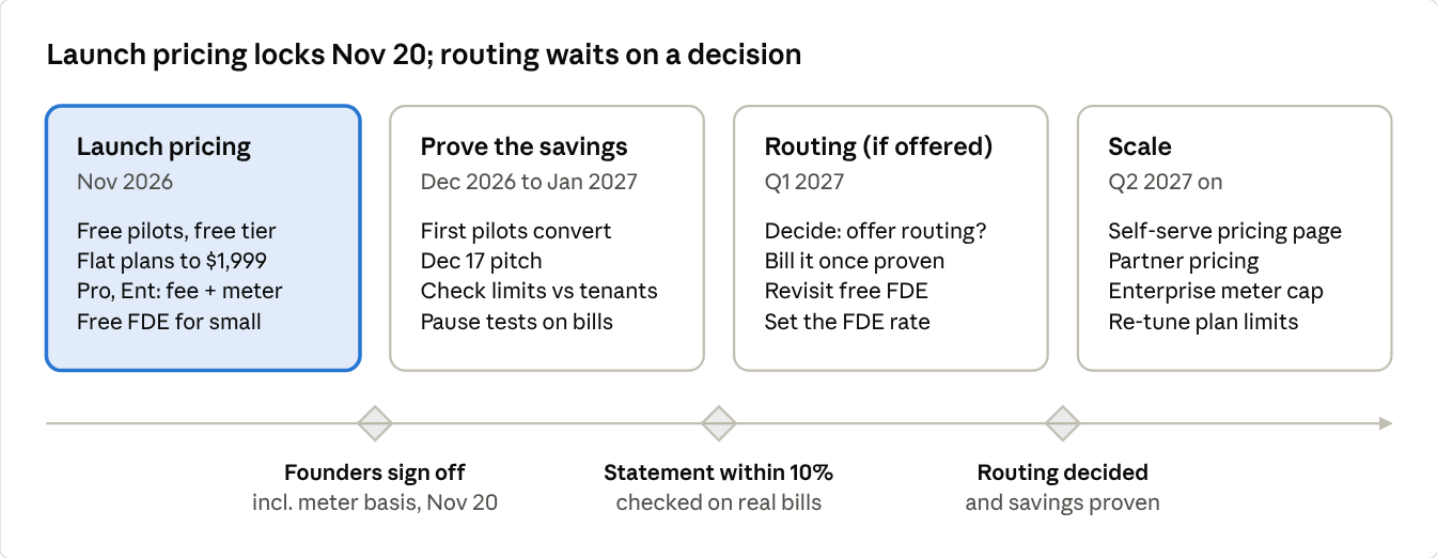
Option	What it does	How it charges	Airbrx angle
Airbrx	Memory for repeat queries; routing misses to the right warehouse is an open question	Free tier and fixed plans; Pro and Enterprise add a meter	One install; fixed for most teams, metered for large accounts

Option	What it does	How it charges	Airbrx angle
Keebo	Automatic warehouse tuning and query routing (Snowflake, Databricks)	About 40% of savings (SELECT)	Same endpoint model; we remove repeats first, then route (if offered)
Espresso AI	Proxy that routes each query and scales warehouses (Snowflake)	Share of savings	Snowflake only; no memory
Yuki	Dynamic routing for Snowflake	Not checked	Snowflake only
Native result caches	Free exact-match caching inside Snowflake and Databricks	Included	Narrow: exact text, 24 h, data unchanged; Databricks needs the warehouse running

Whether to offer routing at all is open. If Airbrx does, it would start as FDE setup competing against their software, with price, free setup for small teams and memory as the edge.

Roadmap

Outstanding Pricing launches as drafted, then each later step waits on proof from real bills. Dates after Dec 17 are drafts.



Pricing roadmap: 4 phases, 3 gates

Risks and open decisions

Measurement gates billing only if the large-account meter is a savings share. Either way, the biggest risk is credibility: the savings statement has to match the real bill change, or the ROI story falls apart.

Risks

- **Business to Pro jump:** $1,999 to $2,999 plus the meter. Pro must also sell on governance features (audit log, custom rules, SSO).

- **Thin savings at low volume:** at 10k queries/day, caching alone saves little unless repeats are high. Routing (if offered) and the free tier would carry these customers.
- **Free FDE time:** unpaid work that doesn't scale. Cap hours per customer and track payback as plan upgrades.
- **Ending launch offers:** customers on free FDE or long pilots will expect them to continue. Say up front they are launch offers.
- **Audit log vs the pitch:** the pitch promises a full audit log of AI queries; this plan keeps the full log on Pro. Adjust one or the other.
- **Storage cost on flat plans:** absorbed in margin for now; a cache-size limit may be needed.

Outstanding Open decisions for the founders

- ☐ **Can Airbrx accurately measure savings per tenant?** Michael to confirm the method and effort; needed for the statement, and for billing if the meter is a savings share
- ☐ **Routing:** is there intent to offer it at all, manual (FDE) or automated? If so, effort and timing
- ☐ Approve the model: free pilot, free forever with a cap, fixed plans through Business, platform fee plus meter on Pro and Enterprise, savings as proof on every plan. Set where the free-tier cap sits
- ☐ Accuracy target for the savings statement and how we prove it (draft: within 10%)
- ☐ Postgres-only pricing: estimated compute saved, or requests
- ☐ Pro and Enterprise meter basis: usage (cached requests or ABUs) or 20% of cost avoided; ceiling or annual true-up for Enterprise
- ☐ FDE rate for Pro and Enterprise, and whether pilots include routing setup
- ☐ Hour cap on free FDE help for small customers, and when to revisit the policy
- ☐ Who approves pilot extensions and the free year
- ☐ Confirm the features marked † (users, SSO/SAML, audit export, SIEM export, uptime SLA)
- ☐ Check limits and prices against current tenants (Ben's data)